

Samy Haffoudhi

PhD Student in Natural Language Processing

+33 (0)7 70 04 10 13

haffoudhisamy@gmail.com

samyhaff.github.io

Google Scholar · GitHub · LinkedIn

Research interests

Information extraction and entity linking · Knowledge graphs · Reasoning and generalization in LLMs · LLM post-training (RL, distillation) · Mechanistic interpretability

Publications

- ISWC 2026 **LELA: an LLM-based Entity Linking Approach with Zero-Shot Domain Adaptation**
S. Haffoudhi, F. M. Suchanek, N. Holzenberger. *International Semantic Web Conference (ISWC)*, Bari, Italy, 2026. arXiv:2601.05192
- IJCAI 2026 **LELA: An End-to-end LLM-based Entity Linking Framework with Zero-shot Domain Adaptation**
S. Haffoudhi, N. Dobričić, F. M. Suchanek, N. Holzenberger. *Int. Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI-ECAI)*, Demo Track, Bremen, Germany, 2026. arXiv:2605.26956

Experience

- 2025 - 2028 **PhD Student**, *Télécom Paris, Institut Polytechnique de Paris*, DIG team, Plateau de Saclay, France.
◦ Project: Knowledge-based Language Models; advisors: Prof. Fabian M. Suchanek and Assoc. Prof. Nils Holzenberger
◦ Research on entity disambiguation and linking, large language models and knowledge graphs
◦ Designed LELA, a modular LLM-based entity linking method with zero-shot domain adaptation
- Sep. - Nov. 2026 **Visiting Researcher**, *Sapienza University of Rome*, Sapienza NLP group, Rome, Italy.
3-month research visit on entity disambiguation and large language models.
- January 2023 **Student Software Engineer**, *Microsoft*, Lyngby, Denmark.
- June 2024 Developer Tools team of Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central: AL language compiler and Visual Studio Code extension. Large C# and TypeScript codebase, test-driven development, bug fixes and new features.
- April - Sept. 2022 **Research Internship**, *THALES*, Plateau de Saclay, France.
Deep metric learning and multitask learning for audio: voice activity detection, audio signal classification and source separation.

Teaching and service

- 2025 - 2026 Teaching assistant at Télécom Paris for 10 courses, including *Knowledge Base Construction*, *Language Modeling*, *Large-scale Generative Models for NLP and Speech* and *Information Extraction and NLP*. Supervision of Data Science and AI student projects.
- Service Reviewer for AKBC 2026 (Workshop on Automated Knowledge Base Construction) and for *Machine Learning* (Springer).

Education

- 2022–2024 **MSc in Computer Science and Engineering**, *DTU (Technical University of Denmark)*, Lyngby, Denmark.
Thesis: *Implementation and evaluation of recent neuroevolution algorithms*, supervised by Prof. Carsten Witt.
- 2020–2024 **MEng, Engineering School**, *École Centrale de Nantes*, Nantes, France.
A highly selective French School of Engineering. **Data analysis and processing specialization:** statistics, machine learning, signal and image processing, algorithms, databases.
- 2018–2020 **"Classes préparatoires"** (mathematics, computer science, physics), *Lycée Janson de Sailly*, Paris, France.
Intensive 2-year program preparing for the national engineering school entrance exams.

Skills and languages

- Tools **Python, Rust, C/C++, C#, Java, OCaml, Bash, SQL, Linux, Git, Docker, L^AT_EX**
- Languages **French** (native), **English** (fluent, TOEFL 2022: 108/120), German, Spanish and Arabic (basics)